

Many businesses in India and China, for instance, produce goods that fit a certain niche for European and American markets largely driven by the purchasing power of the population there.

And since logistics has improved significantly all over developing hot-spots, internet sellers and e-commerce giants are raising the bar for market research done before importing a certain product.

Even manufacturing industries have jumped on the bandwagon due to some attractive options being available on online platforms for obtaining everything from raw materials, machines and even complete pilot plant components. An estimated 300,000 requests are published every month globally for industrial components on portals and forums which are met to a great extent by foreign producers.

The reason? Reduced manufacturing costs. Many businesses today find importing products, components of products and resources more affordable than producing them locally. Think of it as outsourcing with added benefits.

There are many cases where consumers and even entrepreneurs find products of good quality which are inexpensive even when the overall import expenses are included. It's no surprise that an estimated 73 percent of buyers from Amazon, Facebook Marketplace, OLX and Flipkart would prefer buying items online from imported brands rather than local contenders. This does leave the question of just what such businesses would have to do to win back a large consumer base that is turning the tables on national companies.

Consumers and entrepreneurs

One of the key benefits of importing products is the opportunity to become a market leader in the industry of interest. Niches and people are stunned at the vast choices available online on everything from the smallest to even the most



Supplies And Demands

specific of products. Maybe you're a staunch supporter of Manchester United who loves having the team logo on every utensil? Or maybe you're looking for a sound recording setup that's the real deal? All the specific and overly narrow searches would never be fulfilled